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Email Marketing Tips for Increased Lead Sales – Part Four



By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer

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Your online business thrives on inbound traffic. Increasing traffic to your site helps sell leads. Once, you only needed to build a legitimate email list of people wanting to hear from you. But each day there seems to be new tactics for an affiliate marketer to consider.

This is an ongoing series where we examine tips and tactics that will help your email marketing convert more visitors into **sales leads**. Previously in this series:

1. [Building Trust](#)
2. [Subject Lines](#)
3. [Personality](#)

Now we will take a look at the looming change coming soon to the promotions tab on Gmail's web client. Previously, the big G added the promotions tab to filter marketing emails, then it allowed marketers to use Schema.org markup to create [action buttons](#) for recipients. Now, Google is preparing the wide scale release of [grid view](#) for promotional emails.



4. Google's Promotional Email Grid View

Grid view is currently in an open [field trial](#) with a wide release assumed for later this year. As of this writing, there has been no official release date announced. With this change, Google hopes to take a boring list of promotional emails and give them a Pinterest-like appearance. Google is introducing Grid View in hope of catching more users' eyes during the split second of attention most will give an unsolicited email.

Google is once again forcing the marketing community to change its practices to adapt to the firm's shifting goal posts. It would be easy to condemn Google for forcing its dominance on all things search and email. But, if you look at the potential benefits of this change, you might recognize this as an opportunity to stand out in the cluttered world of promotional emails.

All it takes is a few extra steps, and if you adopt this change early enough, you may stand head and shoulders above your competition.

The four components that make up your square in the grid include:

- **A Featured Image**
- **The Sender Image**
- **The Sender's Name**
- **Your Subject Line**

Featured Image

You select a featured image from the web using [Schema.org markup](#). This image must be at least 580px x 400px. Simply include this microdata in your email:

```
<div itemscope itemtype="http://schema.org/Offer">  
<link itemprop="image" href="http://www.example.com/product_image.jpg"/>  
</div>
```

If you don't include this markup, Google will attempt to guess what image in your email to feature. The results can lead to less than satisfying cropping or incorrect use of an inconsequential photo as the featured image.

Sender Image

The sender image is a thumbnail photo pulled from the brand's verified Google+ account. There's been much recent talk about the future of Google+. This feature may be an attempt to keep Google+ relevant to marketers.

If a marketer doesn't have a verified Google+ account, or prefers to participate in the big G's social network, the first letter of the marketer's brand name will appear in a simple serif font.

Sender Name

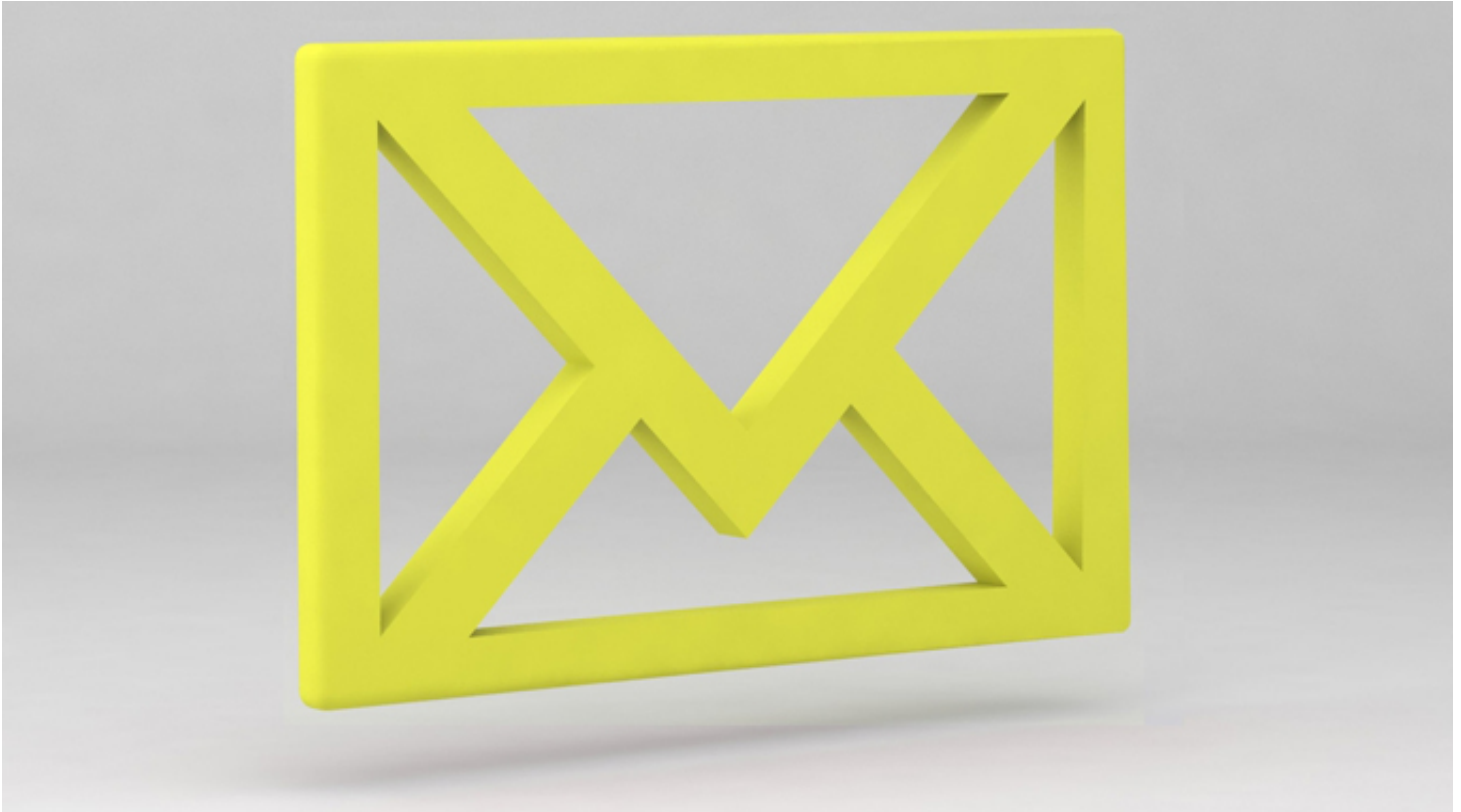
Not surprisingly, the sender name will be populated by the "from" field of the email. This makes the sender image the only element of these four being pulled from the G+ network.

There hasn't been any word on if the G+ integration can be sidestepped through schema markup, but there may one day be a workaround, depending on the future of the big G's social network.

The sender name will be truncated at 20 characters, so if you have an especially long brand name, consider a shorter version so there's no confusion if it gets cut in grid view.

Subject Line

Similar to the sender's name, the subject line is pulled straight from the email. But remember to pay attention to the screen real estate each square gets on the grid. Subject lines will be truncated after 75 characters, so plan accordingly.



Takeaway

Grid view is still in the beta-invite testing phase. Google has yet to give an official date of wide release, but we are expecting this to be released at some point in 2014. Since updating your marketing emails with these changes will not affect how people outside the beta will view your email, it is advised to make the necessary alterations to your marketing emails sooner rather than later.

There is a [preview tool](#) available to test what your emails will look like in grid view before sending them to your distribution lists.

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BIO

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Hailing from Chicago and a product of the Illinois public school system, Chaz Wilke is a professional writer who has written for newspaper, TV, radio, video games, blogs, and film. In his spare time, Chaz enjoys hiking and discovering the hidden gems and oddities of Los Angeles. He also juggles.

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